

U.S. History





About the Course

Read about U.S. history from 1800-1900 through books that immerse students in the time period and allow them to see the world through the eyes of those who lived it. Through engaging narratives, history spines, primary source documents, and books that show different perspectives, students come to see history as more than dates and events and develop relationships with people from the past. Viewing images, looking at maps, and working on one's Book of Centuries are also part of developing this relationship.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

U.S. history may be suitable for 9th graders as well if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-8	U.S. History: Grades 7-8 2 times/week 30 min	A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860 Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship A Year in the South: 1865 Sacajawea Gold Mountain

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 7-8 (U.S.)				
	World History: Grades 7-8 U.S. History: Grades 7-8		Ancient History: Grades 7-9 U.S. History: Grades 7-8	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8



A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860



Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship



A Year in the South: 1865



Sacajawea



Gold Mountain



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timelines Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 7 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 8 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



U.S. History: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any necessary links.
- If you have not read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.
- Decide which lessons/books to read together and which to have students read independently.



Recap

- Connect back to the previous lesson. Have students give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)
- If the previous passage is difficult to remember, teachers may ask a leading question: "What can you tell me about..." Or students may try looking back at any chapter/section headings or illustrations or reading the first paragraph to jog the memory.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson (often included in lesson plans).
- If necessary, talk about a few unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud or have the student read independently. Sometimes reading for the specified time is a better guide.
- If a book is challenging, try stopping to narrate every now and then rather than waiting until the end. It can also help to read aloud. Or you might want to use an audiobook version of the text and have students read along with it.
- Have students keep an eye out for events or characters to add to their Citizenship Notebook, Book of Centuries, or Copywork Book.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally or write a narration.
- Alternatively, students might analyze a character, trace cause to consequence, outline a passage, or use one of the other methods indicated by Charlotte Mason in School Education Chapter 16, especially p.180.
- Students who enjoy writing can experiment with different types of written narrations, but this is not required.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made (orally or in writing).

- You could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question to stimulate discussion. Discussion questions are often included in the lesson plans.



Connect

- Optional: Add something to the Book of Centuries, Century Chart, Citizenship Notebook, or Commonplace book. If students would like to include pictures, these may be drawn or printed.

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

The War of 1812

Materials: PDF Link

→ INTRO

1.This year you are studying the time period 1800-1900. The books we are reading begins in 1820. Today's lesson will highlight some significant events that happened before 1820 and we will begin the book next week. The American Revolution ended in 1783 with the signing of the Treaty of Paris where the U.S. was acknowledged as a sovereign nation. In 1800, the U.S. population totaled 5.3 million, including one million African Americans, of whom 900,000 were enslaved.

2.Imagine what life was like in the U.S. in the early 1800's. Describe what you know about transportation, communication, food production, and clothing. Many important inventions were created during this time and people's way of life changed due to the Industrial Revolution. Watch this video to learn more about this.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Industrial Revolution (8:00)

- What inventions do you think were the most impactful for people at that time? What are some of the inventions you are most grateful for?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

This is a chapter from Joy Hakim's book A History of US, Volume 4.

∞ PDF Link: The War of 1812

-

• IMPORTANT DATES

The War of 1812 begins in the winter.

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

The Beginning of the story

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

By the age of 16, Sacajawea had been kidnapped from her tribe, gambled away to be a man's second wife, and was pregnant with that man's baby. That's when she would join the journey of Meriwether Lewis and William Clark down the Mississippi River and to the Pacific Ocean. But, where did her story begin?

Joseph Bruchac, will explore the early life of Sacajawea as well as recounting her journey with Lewis and Clark which became one of the most famous expeditions to take place in American History. While it is well researched and Joseph Bruchac uses primary sources, like the journals of Lewis and Clark, as support for the story, it remains a work of fiction. There is much that we don't know about Sacajawea's story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Begin with the "Author's Note", p.195-199. Read the Prologue, Ch. 1.

- How different Sacajawea's life would have been if she had stayed amongst her people?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Jefferson is voted in as the 3rd president of the United States in 1800

• TERMINOLOGY

The Minnatree tribe were also known as the Hidatsa tribe. Hidatsa is the more common name.

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Antebellum, The Long Way West

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

Where can we find the words "We hold these truths to be self-evident,

DEFINITIONS

yeoman farmer (p.10): a person who owns and cultivates a small farm

cash crop (p.10): a readily salable crop (such as cotton or tobacco)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

that all men are created equal, that they are endowed by their Creator with certain unalienable Rights, that among these are Life, Liberty and the pursuit of Happiness"? (Declaration of Independence) What would you say is happiness? What did people in the 1800's think it was? For many people it meant owning land. This year, you will read extensively about people exploring new lands, migrating to new places, and the formation of new states.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Poem on p.5
2. Preface & Ch.1 p.9-15 (Read the narrative and then go back and read captions and sidebars)

- How did Long describe his findings from the edge of the plains of the Mississippi woodlands to the Rocky Mountains?

produced or gathered primarily for market

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

In the election of 1800, Thomas Jefferson was announced as the third president of the United States. Arguably, one of his greatest actions as president came to be known as the Louisiana Purchase. Around summer of 1803, after the Louisiana purchase, Thomas Jefferson would choose a group of people including William Clark and Meriwether Lewis to explore the newly acquired land. They would be called the Corps of Discovery.

→ VIEW

∞ Link: Louisiana Purchase, 1803

Read through the page and view the map for more information about the Louisiana purchase.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3

- How did Clark react when Lewis reached out to him about the exploration?
- How did Sacajawea describe her time with the Minnetaree people?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Jefferson completes the Louisiana Purchase 1803
Thomas Jefferson sends Lewis and Clark on the expedition in 1804

DEFINITIONS

ensign (p.9)-a junior officer in the military

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Mountain Men, Riding the Santa Fe Trail

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.2-3 p.16-25

- Why was the discovery of the South Pass so important?
- Why did people travel the Santa Fe Trail?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

York, Stories up the River, and Looking for Indians

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

One of the men who aided in the expedition was a man named York who had grown up enslaved by the Clark Family. He would be helpful on the expedition, but Lewis and Clark also knew that they needed someone that

• NOTE -

quality is intentionally misspelled as this is how it's written in the journal.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Due to some of the writing, skip pg. 20-22

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

knew the lands they were sent to explore. These lands had been places no white man had ever entered before.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-6 p.23-33 start at "Bad as the," end "a Supr. quallity"

- What were some struggles that the expedition encountered early on?

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Trail of Tears

Materials: PDF link

→ INTRO

The settler's wanted more land. The Native American Tribes, inhabited this land. So between 1816 and 1840, Tribes including Cherokees, Chickasaws, Creeks, Seminoles and Choctaws signed treaties that gave up their land to the US. Around 1829, Andrew Jackson and Congress passed an act called the Indian Removal Act that forced remaining tribes to move west. There were over 100,000 Native Americans that were forced from their homes to make a journey that many of them would not survive.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

PDF Link: Trail of Tears (from Hakim's History of US Vol.4)

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Madison elected as president and serves from 1809-1817.

• EXTRA HELPING

This video takes you through a part of the Trail of Tears as it looks now.

∞ Video Link: Trail of Tears

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Looking for Indians, Little Mice

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

The news about the expedition had spread and tribe's awaited the vessel which was rumored to be "a boat with many guns." Lewis and Clark's expedition also served another purpose. They were to act as messengers to the tribe's that they had a new leader: the President of The United States.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7 p.33-44 start at "those plains were" to end.

- How are Lewis and Clark greeted by the various tribes they encounter?
- How does Sacajawea remember the arrival of the Clark expedition?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Susan Magoffin's Diary, Pioneers: Taking the Trail West

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.4-5 p.26-35 stop at "yours, Jeremiah Fish"

- What were some of reasons for going on the Santa Fe Trail or going West?

• IMPORTANT DATES

James Monroe elected as president and serves from 1817-1825

1820 Missouri Compromise.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Making Peace, the White Men's Fort,

Materials: Sacajawea

→ INTRO

One of the biggest dangers when encountering explorers, was what they brought with them. Small pox was one such danger and Native American's and their remedies were no match for the virus. For those who survived the virus, it left them scarred. Though there had been some remedies that showed improvement, the reality was that Native American tribes were ill-prepared to face such a virus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8-9 p.45-59

- How does Sacajawea describe the fort?

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Getting There, Latter-Day Saints

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6-7, p.38-47

- What would it have been like to travel in a wagon train?

• IMPORTANT DATES

John Quincy Adams elected as president and serves from 1825-1829

Indian Removal Act of 1830

Martin Van Buren elected as president and serves from 1837-1841

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12

Charbonneau's Demands, Departures

Materials: Sacajawea

Note: We are skipping ch. 10 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.11-12 p.63-73

- What benefits did one receive for being on the expedition with Lewis and Clark?

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Coast-to-Coast Destiny, Texas: Tempting and Beautiful

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

Note: We are skipping ch. 9 since we are reading about Frémont in geography.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.8 & 10 p.48-53; 58-63

• IMPORTANT DATES

James K. Polk elected as president and serves from 1845-1849

Gold Rush of 1849 in California

Compromise of 1850

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 1

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

The Great Falls, Flash Flood, The Three Forks

Materials: Sacajawea

Note: We are skipping ch. 13-15 for the sake of time.

→ INTRO

Sacajawea found herself able to help the expedition in more ways than just translating for her people. Growing up in the village, she knew that there would come a time where it would be impossible to hunt, and that the survival of people depended on find food in other ways. Mainly she taught them how to forage for edible roots.

There would be more difficulties then just running low on food. One of the largest would-be grizzly bears. Even though Lewis and Clark were outfitted with guns and bullets, they had a hard time taking down the Grizzlies which caused Captain Lewis to say “these bears being so hard to die rather intimidates me.” A canoe nearly sank, animals charged their tents and Sacajawea came down with an illness.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16-18 p.90-104

- How does Sacajawea help guide Lewis and Clark? What does she contribute to the company of explorers?

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Gold, Clipper Ships, and the Pony Express

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 11-12 p.64-78

- How did Clipper Ships and the Pony Express impact the United States?

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

What do you Call Us and Finding the Shoshones

Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19-20 p.105-120

- Why were the Shoshones hesitant to follow Captain Lewis?

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Flying By Stagecoach, Arithmetic at Sea

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

• IMPORTANT DATES

William Henry Harrison elected as president and serves in 1841
William Henry Harrison gets sick and dies after only just 31 days in office.

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Term 1

Ch.13-14, p.78-89

- What is something that shocked you in this reading?

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Reunion, The Welcome,

Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21-23 p.121-133

- How does Sacajawea react to finding her tribe? Her family?

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Thar She Blows, A Boy From Japan

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

Whaling is just one of the many industries that became more and more popular in the 1800s.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 15-16 p.90-101

- Does anything shock you in this week's reading?

• IMPORTANT DATES

John Tyler becomes president and serves from 1841-1845

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

The Terrible Trail, Quamash, Many Rapids, Many Nations,

Materials: Sacajawea

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.24-26 p.134-146

- Why was writing so important to Lewis and Clark?

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Cities of Progress, A Land of Movers

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 17-18 p.101-111

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Term 1

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22 <i>The Great Hungry Water, At Fort Clatsop, Thieves, Doctoring the Nez Percé</i> Materials: Sacajawea → RECAP Think about where you've left off. → READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS Ch.27-30 p.147-161 • List the people that Lewis and Clark encounter in the chapter? How do Lewis and Clark interact with each person?	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: A HISTORY OF US: LIBERTY FOR ALL?: 1820-1860	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: SACAJAWEA	

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Workin' on the Railroad, She Wishes to Ornament Their Minds

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch. 19-20 p.112-119

- How would the railroad affect people differently?

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Waiting for Mr. Lincoln, Born into Slavery

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship

→ INTRO

This book begins in 1863, two years after the Civil War started. Abraham Lincoln was the President and never thought the war would last this long. He was trying to hold the country together as best he could. Frederick Douglass, who was a formerly enslaved man, became one of the strongest voices against slavery. Although Lincoln and Douglass initially disagreed about various matters, their discussions were profitable and instrumental to the cause of freedom.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1-2 p.1-17

- What does the rule against teaching a slave to read tell you about the importance of books?
- How did learning to read influence the decisions of Frederick?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the sentence on p.12 where Frederick talks about taking his life.

• DEFINITIONS

calling card: Also known as a visiting card, it was a small, decorative card that was carried by individuals to present themselves to others (p.2)

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Do Girl's Have Brains, Seneca Falls and the Rights of Women

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21-22 p.120-129

- How did people view women in the 1800s? How did that change through the years?

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Soul on Fire, Nothing but Plenty of Friends

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.3-4 p.19-41

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

- What do you find interesting about Douglass' journey from a slave to a famous writer and lecturer?
- How did Lincoln become a self-made man?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

A Woman Named Truth, Life in the Mills, Working Women and Children

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.23-25 p.130-140

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Why Sojourner Truth Changed Her Name
Watch the video to learn more about Sojourner Truth.

- What did you learn about Sojourner in the reading or the video?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

A House Divided, Debating the Future of Slavery in America

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship

→ RECAP

Briefly summarize what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.5-6 p.43-63

- What do you think about Lincoln's view of slavery at this point? Do you disagree with any aspects of it?

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

American Writers, Mr. Thoreau at Home With the World

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ INTRO

George Ticknor said, "It was time for American's to write their stories." And write them they did. The 1800s would be filled with famous writers from Ralph Waldo Emerson to Louisa Alcott whose works still impact modern day society.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.26-27 pg.141-145

- How familiar are you with the writers of the 1800s? Have you read or interacted with any of the books mentioned in this section?
- Thoreau wrote, "In Wildness is the preservation of the World." Do you agree?

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Emancipation, Mr. Douglas...I Am Glad to See You

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7-8 65-85

- Why didn't Lincoln initially think he had the authority to free the slaves?
- What does it say about President Lincoln that even though Frederick couldn't agree with him, he could "respect his humane spirit"?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Melville and Company, Painter of Birds and Painter of Indians

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.28-29 pg.146-156

→ VIEW

∞ Link: John J. Audubon's Birds of America

Take a minute to look through the Bird's of America gallery. Choose your favorite and try and sketch it.

- What is John James Audubon famous for?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Lincoln's Secret Plan, My Friend Douglass

Materials: Abraham Lincoln and Frederick Douglass: The Story Behind and American Friendship

→ RECAP

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9-10

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Amistad means Friendship, Webster Defends the Union

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

Note: We are skipping ch.31 because we are reading about John James Audubon in geography.

→ RECAP

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

Think about where you've left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.30 & 32 pg.157-165

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ INTRO

This historical novel is based on around the building of the transcontinental railroad which took place from 1863-1869. It was an arduous, dangerous job for the men who signed up to do it. Nearly 12,000 Chinese workers toiled for more than four years to complete the western section of the railroad and connect the coasts. This story will bring this time period to life and give you a glimpse of what those workers endured so they could send money back to their families in China.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.Read author's note p.274-276

2.p.1-12 Beginning -"to say or do."

- What customs or traditions in Chinese culture have you noticed so far?"

→ BACKGROUND

Foot binding — the practice of applying tight binding to the feet of young girls to prevent further growth — was a Chinese custom historically associated with the wealthy. Small feet were considered more attractive and therefore necessary to find a more suitable partner. It was banned in 1911, but the practice continued in rural areas until circa 1949, when women were forced to remove the bindings on their "lotus feet" by governmental decree.

This video explains the Taiping Rebellion which Ling Fan's dad was accused of being a part of.

∞ Video Link: Taiping Rebellion

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 37

Big Problems and a Little Giant

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

Note: We are skipping ch.34-35 because those topics are covered in the Lincoln & Douglass book.

→ RECAP

Think about where you've left off.

→ IN THE NOVEL MASTER SLAVE HUSBAND WIFE, ILYON WOO WROTE THE STORY OF WILLIAM AND AND ELLEN CRAFT. SHE WROTE, "IN 1848 WILLIAM AND ELLEN CRAFT, AN ENSLAVED COUPLE IN GEORGIA, EMBARKED UPON A FIVE-THOUSAND-MILE JOURNEY OF MUTUAL SELF-EMANCIPATION ACROSS THE WORLD. THEIRS IS A LOVE STORY THAT BEGINS IN A TIME OF REVOLUTION —A REVOLUTION UNFINISHED IN THE AMERICAN WAR FOR INDEPENDENCE, A REVOLUTION THAT ENDURES." AS YOU READ THROUGH THEIR STORY, TAKE NOTE OF ALL THE DIFFERENT THINGS THAT THEY NEEDED TO DO IN ORDER TO ESCAPE INTO FREEDOM.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.33 & 36 pg.166-171

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

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Term 2

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 38

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

What is going on so far in the story?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.13-26 "Ling Fan shook" - "hot as cinder."

- What do you notice about the way marriage is approached in that culture?

→ BACKGROUND

Qingming is a festival for honoring ancestors that is celebrated on the 15th day after the spring equinox generally falling in early April. The main activity is the cleaning or sweeping of ancestral tombs, and thus it is sometimes referred to as "Tomb Sweeping Day." The festival is an ancient one, dating back at least 2,500 years in Chinese history. (mentioned on p.23 of book)

★ TEACHER NOTE

There is a reference to a woman's cycle on p.25.

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 39

Materials: Book of Centuries, A History of US (optional)

→ NOTEBOOK

Take this time to work on your Book of Centuries. Dates are in the various lessons or on p.199. Don't forget to draw items as well. There are examples in the back of the Our Work books.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Zachery Taylor elected as president and serves from 1849-1850

Millard Fillmore elected as president and serves from 1850-1853

Franklin Pierce elected as president and serves from 1853-1857

James Buchanan elected as president and serves from 1857-1861

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 40

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ LOCATE

1. Locate the Pearl River. The ship went down this river to the village where Ling Fan lived.

2. Find Guangzhou. This is the busy seaport where men board a bigger ship bound for America.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.26-40 "That night" - she stepped forward."

→ BACKGROUND

Why did the Chinese call America "Gold Mountain"?

In the 1840s, the news circled the globe: There was gold in California, and fortunes could be made by anyone who seized the opportunity. Within weeks, dreamers from far and wide came streaming into America's port cities, hoping to stake a claim and strike it rich. China was not immune to this new gold fever. Word of a mountain of gold across the ocean arrived in Hong Kong in 1849, and quickly spread throughout the Chinese provinces. By 1851, 25,000 Chinese immigrants had left their homes and moved to California, a land some came to call *gam saan*, or "gold mountain". (from History of Congress website)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 41

Architecture

Materials: Notebook

NOTE:

For the next three weeks you will be learning about different styles of homes that were common in American in the 1800s.

→ **INTRO: AROUND 1820 A MOVEMENT OF OLD WORLD ARCHITECTURAL STYLES GAINED POPULARITY IN THE U.S. THE FIRST OF THESE MOVEMENTS WAS INSPIRED BY THE TEMPLES OF ANCIENT GREECE.**

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

→ **SKETCH: LOOK AT THE GREEK REVIVAL HOUSE AND SKETCH ANY DETAILS YOU WOULD LIKE INTO YOUR NOTEBOOK.**

★ Image: Greek Revival House

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 42

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. Skip the beginning of the chapter (p.41-47) for the sake of time and some crass descriptions.

2. p.47-61 ("Sometime in the middle"- "the new country.")

- Do you think Ling Fan's plan will work or will she be found out?

→ VIEW

Throughout the lessons you will be watching segments from a webinar that was hosted by the Chinese Railroad Workers in North America Project at Stanford University. Some people might think that history is about dates and events and that there is nothing new to find out about the past. But when we look at primary sources there might be "new stories" to uncover that are not part of the usual narrative. That is what historians do. They study primary sources to answer questions about the past. Primary sources are forms of evidence that come directly from the period or persons or events we are seeking to understand. These can be journals, letters, photos, newspapers and other writings. That is what this project is about. We don't know a lot about the Chinese railroad workers that came to America in the late 1800s to find jobs and built up America. These historians are trying to bring these stories to us.

This segment talks about the project and the kinds of primary sources they studied.

∞ Video Link: Stanford University Research (7:30-11:30)

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 43

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
Ch.37-38

• Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 44**

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ **RECAP**
Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
p.62-74 "Perhaps the immanent" - "San Francisco sunshine."

→ **VIEW**
This part of the webinar talks about the kinds of ships the Chinese sailed on.
∞ Video Link: Stanford University Research (11:40-14:48)

★ **TEACHER NOTE**
Note the use of curse words on p.74. One today's reading and one in the next reading.

WEEK 11 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 45** *Main Idea/Subtitle*

Materials: A History of US: Liberty for All?: 1820-1860

→ **CATCH UP USE THIS TIME TO CATCH UP ON LESSONS IN THIS OR ANOTHER COURSE, OR EXPLORE EXTRA HELPINGS.**

WEEK 11 **30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 46**

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ **RECAP**
Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ **INTRO**
By 1861, an engineer named Theodore Judah had enlisted a group of investors in Sacramento to form the Central Pacific Railroad Company. He then headed to Washington, DC where he was able to convince congressional leaders as well as President Lincoln who signed the Pacific Railroad Act into law the following year. The Central Pacific Railroad Company would start building in Sacramento and continue east across the Sierra Nevada, while a second company, the Union Pacific Railroad, would build westward from the Missouri River, near the Iowa-Nebraska border.
The two lines of track would meet in the middle (the bill did not designate an exact location) and each company would receive 6,400 acres of land (later doubled to 12,800) and \$48,000 in government bonds for every mile of track built. From the beginning, then, the building of the transcontinental railroad was set up in terms of a competition between the two companies. (from history.com)

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

★ **TEACHER NOTE**
There are two curse words on p.74.
You may choose to skip the last paragraphs on p.82 since it refers to a woman's cycle.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2	
1.p.74-81 "Descending the gangplank" - "they had come) (Skipping p.81-82 for the sake of time and content.) 2.p.83-86 "Payday was the" - "in her fist."	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 47 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: A HISTORY OF US: LIBERTY FOR ALL?: 1820-1860	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 48 → EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: ABRAHAM LINCOLN AND FREDERICK DOUGLASS: THE STORY BEHIND AND AMERICAN FRIENDSHIP	

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 49

Meeting Louis Hughes

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

In 1832, a baby boy is born around Charlottesville, Virginia. His name would be Louis Hughes and he was the son of a black mother and a white father. Louis would marry, have children and live through the events of the Civil War. In his old age, he would write a memoir, sharing his life story. In *A Year in the South*, author and Civil War historian Stephen Ash, uses Louis Hughes' memoir and other additional primary sources to detail one of the most eventful years in the history of the United States: 1865. This is the year that the civil war would come to an end. But what did the victory of the Civil War mean for the men and women still enslaved in the South? When did freedom come? These are just a few of the questions, Stephen Ash will answer in his book.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.19-28

- What surprised you in the reading?

• IMPORTANT DATES

Civil War ends on April 9th, 1865
Lincoln is assassinated on April 14th, 1865

WEEK 1 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 50

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

What kind of dangers do you think the railroad workers faced during the building of the transcontinental railroad?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-97 "Lin Fan stood" - "a lazy cook."

- What kind of dangers did the railroad workers face?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the curse word on p.96.

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 51

Meeting Cornelia McDonald

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

In the prologue of *A Year in the South*, Stephen Ash introduces his audience to Cornelia McDonald. He writes, "When 1865 began, Cornelia McDonald was forty-two years old and living in a rented house in Lexington, Virginia, with her seven children. She was a widow and a war refugee. The death of her husband, a Confederate army officer, and the loss of her home had brought her to the verge of poverty and despair." Cornelia McDonald was born in Virginia. She was born in 1822 to a well off family. Her family had owned slaves and she had grown up never needing to work with her hands. How does the victory of the union in 1865 impact this young mother and widow? Author and Civil War historian Stephen Ash, will use many different primary sources to piece together this young woman's story.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.29-37 stop at "all year round."

- What is something in Cornelia's story that you didn't expect to read?

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 2 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 52

Materials: Gold Mountain

Note: We are skipping ch. 10 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

In ch.10 Ling Fan starts her new job of cooking food for the crew. She assists Tan Din and most of the people complain about the bad food.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.105- 116 "For the next" - "mountain work camps."

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

This section shows pictures of the tents where the workers slept. (34:48-36:55)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the curse word on p.111.

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 53

Meeting Cornelia McDonald Continued...

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.37-45 start at "when an opportunity" and read until the end of the chapter.

- What stood out to you in the reading?

WEEK 3 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 54

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.117- 127 "Storm's coming" - "that bonus money."

- Opium

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 55

Cornelia McDonald In the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

97-107

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

- War impacts everyone, but it does so in many different ways. What are some of the impacts on Cornelia, her family and her town that you see in the reading?

WEEK 4 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 56

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.128-143. "Now more that" - "to find out."

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 57

Louis Hughes in the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

Like many enslaved women and men, Louis Hughes had dreams of being free. He would run away a couple of times and every time he received a punishment. His story highlights the evil that we must face as those who study history. Humans are capable of great evil towards each other. Sin is a part of the human experience and we can trace it to every place and every time.

In his book, *Why Study History*, John Fea writes, "Indeed, anyone who studies the past realizes that there are no heroes in history. While people may perform heroic acts, all humans are tainted by sin and are susceptible to acting in ways that preference themselves over others and God. Historians understand, perhaps better than most, the reality of the pain, suffering, injustice, anger, and vice brought on by sin. In other words, they understand the tragic dimensions of life."

History reminds us of the inherent weakness in the human condition and the very real possibility that our fellow human beings are capable of horrendous things. This should humble us, for "there, but for the grace of God, go I." One day there will be a new heaven and new earth where there will be no more death or mourning or crying or pain.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

109-118 stop at "and poultry alike"

- How does Louis Hughes' story tell you more about what's going on in his community?

WEEK 5 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 58

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.143-156 "There were three" - the base camp.

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

A historian shows photographs of the work it took to lay tracks across mountains. (28:05-30:17)

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 59

Louis Hughes in the Spring

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

pg.122-124 start at "With the war" and read until the end of the chapter.

- What surprised you about Louis Hughes story?

WEEK 6 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 60

Materials: Gold Mountain

Note: We are skipping ch.16 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.172-174 "Snow!"- "into the mountain!"

p.175. "As it turned out" - "

→ VIEW

∞ Video: Stanford University Research

A historian shows photos of the tunnels that had to be created by the workers. (30:19-32:30)

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 61

Louis Hughes in Summer

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

With the surrender of General Lee to Ulysses Grant on April 9th, 1865 and the emancipation proclamation, enslaved men and women waited for their freedom to come as their enslavers did not seem keen on letting them go free without influence from the soldiers.

In June of 1865, Louis Hughes and his wife and children were still waiting for their freedom to come. They waited and waited for their freedom. How long did they have to wait? How long until they could leave the plantation and become free men and women?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

127-135 stop at "join the escape"

- What do you think it was like for people like Louis Hughes to have to wait for their freedom?

WEEK 7 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 62

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

Information

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- Discussion Question Idea

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 63

Louis Hughes in Summer

📖 Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ RECAP

Think back to where you left off.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

135-142 start at “they halted at” and read until the end of the chapter.

- What shocked you in this reading?

WEEK 8 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 64

📖 Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

- Discussion Question Idea

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 65

Cornelia McDonald in Summer

📖 Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ INTRO

Cornelia McDonald was impoverished. Her kids were too busy working to go to school and even if she could make things work, she still couldn't afford to send them to school. The civil war had left her a widow, a single mother and now she found herself barely able to afford to eat and send her kids to school. How did this mother survive summer? How would she stay standing with the everything against her? She was facing the uncertainty of life just as much as anyone else.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

pg.157-166 stop at “demanded their surrender”

- What shocked you in this reading?

WEEK 9 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 66

📖 Materials: Gold Mountain

→ RECAP

Briefly tell what happened last time.

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 67

Cornelia McDonald in Summer and Fall

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ **RECAP**
Think back to where you left off.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**
166-169, start at “although they were” and read until the end of the chapter.
197-204 stop at “when Angus died”

- How did Cornelia's circumstances change in this reading?

WEEK 10 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 68

Materials: Gold Mountain

→ **RECAP**
Briefly tell what happened last time.

→ **INTRO**
Information

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

- Discussion Question Idea

→ **PROMPT**
∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 69

Cornelia McDonald and Louis Hughes in Fall

Materials: A Year in the South: 1865

→ **INTRO**
1865 was a year faced with many uncertainties. As men and women were freed from the bondages of slavery, they would need to find homes, jobs and safe havens where they could relish their freedom. And households that had built their wealth on the backs of slaves, would need to transition quickly to be able to sustain themselves. The year 1865 would be one of the most tumultuous years in the history of the United States, but the fight for freedom didn't end with the emancipation proclamation or the winning of the civil war. The rest of the 1800s would be filled with a struggle for equality that was just beginning.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3	
204-217 start at “She sat down” and read until the end of the chapter.	
• Compare Cornelia McDonald's fall to Louis Hughes fall?	
WEEK 11 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 70	
Materials: Gold Mountain	
→ RECAP Briefly tell what happened last time.	
→ INTRO Information	
→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS	
• Discussion Question Idea	
→ PROMPT ∞ Image Link: Title of Image	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 71	
→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: A YEAR IN THE SOUTH: 1865	
WEEK 12 30m U.S. History: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 72	
→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: GOLD MOUNTAIN	

U.S. History: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

- Describe one part of Sacajawea's journey that stood out to you?
- What is one invention in the 1800s and what is its legacy in our modern day?

Term 3

- You read about Louis Hughes and Cornelia McDonald's lives in the year 1865, after the Civil War ended. Choose one of these people and summarize their lives. What were the big milestones they faced?